

I Took 4 Peptides for 2 Weeks... Here's What Happened

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 10, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=df5cP5HrwV0> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter, a 27-year personal trainer, documents two weeks of taking four peptides (Tirzepatide, Tesofensine/Tesamorelin, MOTS-c, BPC-157) during an extreme 4-day crash cut, finding it dramatically easier than any previous attempt.

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Context: The Protocol and Peptide Stack [0:00](#)

- Brandon just finished week 2 of a peptide protocol; video is a personal experience update, not a full protocol breakdown
 - Full protocol breakdown promised in a future video
- The cut he ran alongside the peptides was described as his "hardest" and "most aggressive" protocol
 - Lost **10 pounds in 4 days**
 - Acknowledges a significant portion was water weight, not all fat
 - Calories held at **~1,400 per day** — very low for a 6'2", 200 lb man
 - Protein kept at nearly **300 grams per day** to preserve muscle during the aggressive deficit
 - Daily calorie burn target: **3,500–4,000 calories**, achieved mostly through walking
 - The protocol was a version of the **protein-sparing modified fast** — near-zero carbs and fats, almost all calories from protein
 - Ran for only 4 days; Brandon frames it as an intentional, short-term crash diet
- Four peptides taken simultaneously:
 - Tirzepatide (GLP-1/GIP agonist)

- Tesamorelin (growth hormone secretagogue)
- MOTS-c (mitochondrial peptide)
- BPC-157 (recovery/healing peptide)
- Key overall verdict: "This was the only time it was damn near easy."

Peptide 1: Tirzepatide — Hunger Elimination 1:21

- Tirzepatide is described as a **GLP peptide similar to Ozempic** but slightly different; prescribed by Brandon's doctor
 - FDA-approved; Eli Lilly markets it as **Mounjaro** and **Zepbound**
 - Available via doctor prescription; many health insurance plans cover it
- Effect: completely eliminated hunger during the cut
 - In past runs of the same protocol, Brandon was "kind of hungry all the time" and had difficulty sleeping due to hunger
 - This time: "I wasn't hungry at all"
- Concrete example of appetite suppression:
 - On one or two days he forgot to eat and had only ~**900 calories** logged before his girlfriend reminded him to eat more
 - "I was forgetting to eat" — something he had never experienced before
- Analogy Brandon uses to describe normal dieting hunger:
 - "When you're walking the dog and the dog wants to do all types of other stuff... you're always just pulling the dog. That dog is like your hunger."
 - On Tirzepatide: "There was no dog. Like no dog. I was just walking."
- Important caveat he raises: **you must track calories when on GLP medications**
 - Without tracking, he says he would have ended up with only ~40g of protein instead of the required 300g
 - Intuitive eating is not viable when appetite is this suppressed on a high-protein protocol
- Even at 1,400 total calories, the last meal of the day felt like "stuffing my face"
- Told his mother (who has struggled with her weight) to talk to her doctor about Tirzepatide

Peptide 2: Tesamorelin — Sleep Quality 4:46

- Tracked sleep using an **Oura Ring**; results described as some of the best sleep of the year
- Normal problem during aggressive cuts:
 - Deep caloric deficit spikes cortisol at night → waking up hungry in the middle of the night
 - Brandon also gets physically cold when fasting deeply, which disrupts sleep
 - Neither issue occurred this time
- Tesamorelin is a **growth hormone secretagogue** (GH agonist) — helps the body release more growth hormone

- FDA-approved; can be prescribed by a doctor
- Additional benefit noted: clinically shown to **clear visceral fat** (fat around the belly)
 - Brandon observed his abs looked tighter, though he acknowledges some of that is from the 10 lb weight loss
- Sleep quality metrics from Oura Ring:
 - Deep sleep: excellent
 - REM sleep: excellent
 - Sleep latency: very low — "almost like I closed my eyes and transported to the next day"
 - Woke up before his alarm on several days (his personal indicator of good sleep quality)
 - Woke up feeling refreshed daily

Peptide 3: MOTS-c — Energy Efficiency 6:36

- Energy typically suffers during extreme cuts; Brandon usually compensates with extra caffeine
 - This time he didn't need as much caffeine
- MOTS-c mechanism (layman's explanation): causes **mitochondria** (the energy-producing part of cells) to release more energy, allowing the body to use energy more efficiently
- Practical result: maintained high energy throughout the day despite a **~2,000–2,600 calorie daily deficit**
 - Not tired, not sleepy, not dragging
 - In past runs of the same protocol: "I kind of feel a little shitty the whole time" — did not feel that way this time

Peptide 4: BPC-157 — Injury Recovery 7:47

- BPC-157 is described as a peptide that improves recovery and heals injuries
- Effects felt beginning in **week 1**
- Relevant background: Brandon has been training for ~two decades and has accumulated multiple minor chronic injuries
 - Recurring issue in his traps
 - A bicep he pulled when he was younger that never fully healed
- Current status of those injuries after two weeks:
 - Bicep: "not 100% healed but it's feeling way better than it did before I started"
 - All the small nagging issues feel like they're "gone"

Safety Notes, Legal Sourcing, and Retatrutide Comparison 4:18

- Brandon repeatedly stresses he is **not a doctor** and is **not telling anyone to take peptides**
 - "Consult your doctor before you do any of this or just don't do it at all"
 - Frames himself as a personal trainer with 27 years of experience who is sharing his own experience only

- All peptides obtained through a **doctor** who checks his bloodwork and prescribes them legally
 - Strongly recommends this route over unregulated sources
- On **Retatrutide (Reta)** — a common question he receives:
 - Cannot be obtained legally, so Brandon won't use it ("the stakes are too high for me to be doing illegal stuff")
 - Hits a **third receptor** (in addition to GLP-1 and GIP), which can raise heart rate
 - A friend had to stop Retatrutide because his heart was "racing too hard" and he felt like he was fainting; switched away and issues resolved
 - Brandon: "I just don't think I need that additional heart rate. I'm pretty turned up enough as is."

Wrap-Up and What's Coming Next 8:36

- Now entering **week 3** of the peptide protocol; results have exceeded expectations
- Plans to continue for at least a full month
- Describes this as "the easiest cut I ever did" despite it being his most aggressive protocol
- Upcoming video: full breakdown of the **4-day, 10-pounds-lost protocol**
 - Brandon's position on crash diets: they can be a useful tool to jump-start a cut or prepare for an upcoming event, not inherently bad when used strategically
- Calls to action: subscribe for the upcoming protocol video

"This was the only time it was damn near easy... It's my most aggressive protocol, and it's never been easier to cut, and it's thanks to these four peptides I've been taking."